A Book of Common Prayer

Sacred Prayers in Many Voices

Version 2026-09-11

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Hail Mary (2026) — original composition written by Steve Price.

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Sources

Traditional and scriptural sources for the prayers in this edition (listed in English for consistency across translations):

• The 23rd Psalm — traditional biblical text (Hebrew Scriptures), public domain.

• Ave Maria — traditional Catholic prayer based on Luke 1, public domain.

• Hail Mary — see note above regarding the 2026 composition.

• Ave Verum Corpus — medieval Eucharistic hymn, traditionally attributed to Pope Innocent VI (14th century), public domain.

• Gloria — traditional liturgical text (Gloria in Excelsis Deo), public domain.

• The Lord's Prayer — from the Gospels (Matthew 6, Luke 11), public domain.

• Magnificat — the Song of Mary, from the Gospel of Luke 1, public domain.

• Miserere (Psalm 51) — traditional biblical text, public domain.

• Nunc Dimittis — the Song of Simeon, from the Gospel of Luke 2, public domain.

• The Peace Prayer — commonly attributed to St. Francis of Assisi; its familiar modern wording dates to the early 20th century.

• Sanctus — traditional liturgical text, drawing on Isaiah 6:3 and Revelation 4:8, public domain.

• The Serenity Prayer — commonly attributed to the American theologian Reinhold Niebuhr.

The 23rd Psalm

The Lord is my shepherd; I shall not want.
He maketh me to lie down in green pastures:
he leadeth me beside the still waters.
He restoreth my soul:
he leadeth me in the paths of righteousness
for his name's sake.
Yea, though I walk through the valley
of the shadow of death,
I will fear no evil: for thou art with me;
thy rod and thy staff they comfort me.
Thou preparest a table before me
in the presence of mine enemies:
thou anointest my head with oil;
my cup runneth over.
Surely goodness and mercy shall follow me
all the days of my life:
and I will dwell in the house of the Lord for ever.
Amen.

Ave Maria

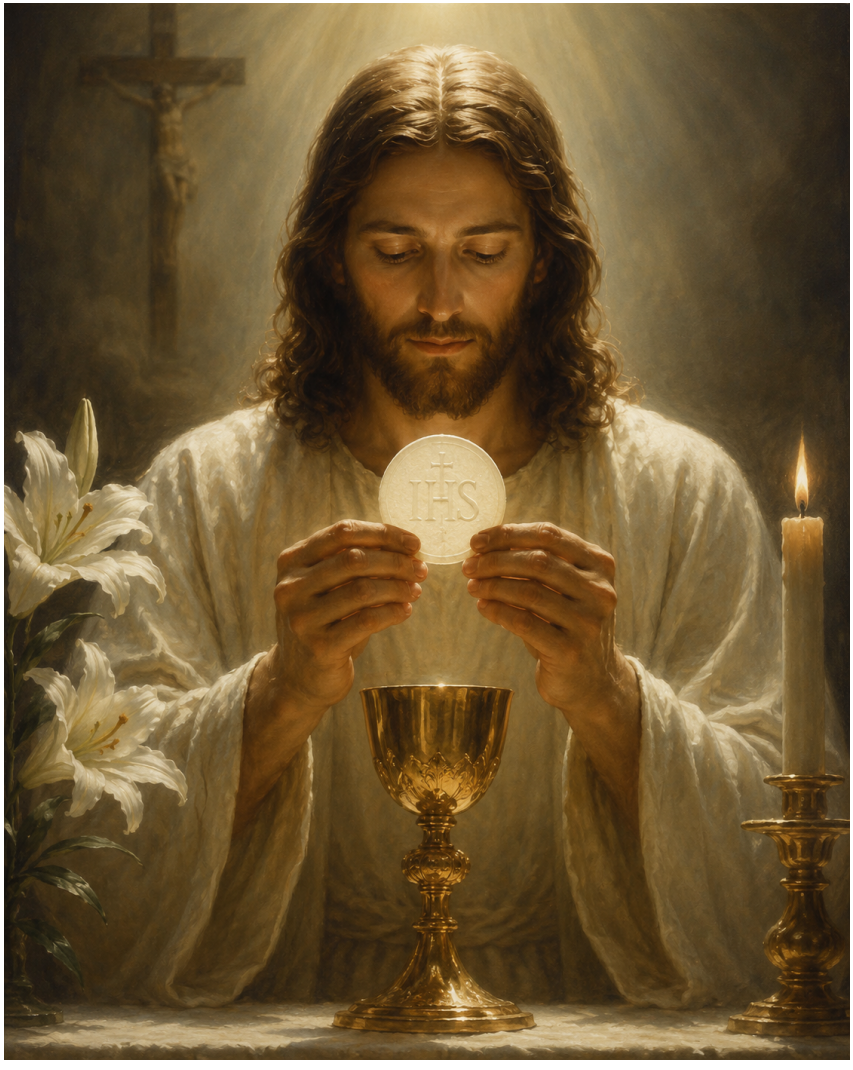
Hail Mary, full of grace, the Lord is with thee.
Blessed art thou among women,
and blessed is the fruit of thy womb, Jesus.
Holy Mary, Mother of God, pray for us sinners,
now and at the hour of our death. Amen.

Hail Mary

Hail Mary, full of grace
I can not wait to see your face
And dwell in that immortal place
Your son has made for every race
Where we shall live without a trace
Of sorrow, tears, or sighing.

Hail Mary, full of grace
I can not wait to see your face
And dwell in that immortal place
Your son has made for every race
Where we shall live without a trace
Of sorrow, tears, or sighing.

Ave Verum Corpus



Hail, true Body, born of the Virgin Mary,
who truly suffered, sacrificed on the cross for mankind,
from whose pierced side flowed water and blood:
be for us a foretaste in the trial of death.

O sweet Jesus, O holy Jesus, O Jesus, son of Mary.
Have mercy on me. Amen.

Gloria

Glory be to the Father,
and to the Son,
and to the Holy Ghost;
as it was in the beginning,
is now, and ever shall be,
world without end.
Amen.

The Lord's Prayer

Our Father, who art in heaven,
hallowed be thy name.
Thy kingdom come, thy will be done,
on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread,
and forgive us our trespasses,
as we forgive those who trespass against us.
And lead us not into temptation,
but deliver us from evil.
For thine is the kingdom, the power, and the glory,
for ever and ever. Amen.

Magnificat

MAGNIFICAT
Magnificat anima mea Dominum,
et exsultavit spiritus meus
in Deo salutari meo.
Quia respexit humilitatem ancillae suae.
Ecce enim ex hoc beatam me dicent
omnes generationes.
Quia fecit mihi magna qui potens est :
et sanctum nomen eius.
Et misericordia eius a progenie in progenies
timentibus eum.
Fecit potentiam in brachio suo :
dispersit superbos mente cordis sui.
Deposuit potentes de sede,
et exaltavit humiles.
Esurientes implevit bonis :
et divites dimisit inanes.
Suscepit Israel puerum suum,
recordatus misericordiae suae.
Sicut locutus est ad patres nostros,
Abraham et semini eius in saecula.
Gloria Patri, et Filio,
et Spiritui Sancto.
Sicut erat in principio,
et nunc, et semper,
et in saecula saeculorum.
Amen.

My soul magnifies the Lord,
and my spirit rejoices in God my Saviour.
For he hath regarded the low estate of his handmaiden:
for behold, from henceforth all generations shall call me
blessed.
For he that is mighty hath done to me great things;
and holy is his name.
And his mercy is on them that fear him
from generation to generation.
He hath showed strength with his arm;
he hath scattered the proud in the imagination of their hearts.
He hath put down the mighty from their seat,
and exalted them of low degree.
He hath filled the hungry with good things;
and the rich he hath sent empty away.
He hath holpen his servant Israel,
in remembrance of his mercy.
As he spake to our fathers,
to Abraham, and to his seed for ever.

Miserere — Psalm 51

Have mercy upon me, O God,
according to thy lovingkindness:
according unto the multitude of thy tender mercies
blot out my transgressions.
Wash me thoroughly from mine iniquity,
and cleanse me from my sin.
For I acknowledge my transgressions:
and my sin is ever before me.
Create in me a clean heart, O God;
and renew a right spirit within me.
Cast me not away from thy presence;
and take not thy holy spirit from me.
Restore unto me the joy of thy salvation;
and uphold me with thy free spirit.
The sacrifices of God are a broken spirit:
a broken and a contrite heart, O God,
thou wilt not despise.
Amen.

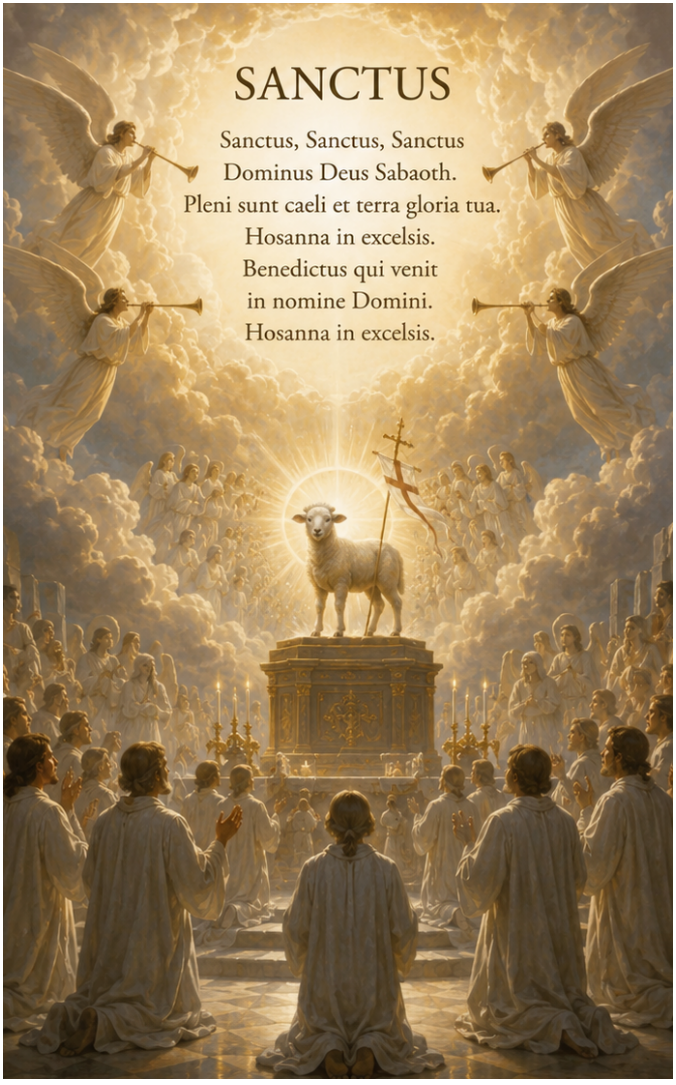
Nunc Dimittis

Lord, now lettest thou thy servant depart in peace,
according to thy word.
For mine eyes have seen thy salvation,
which thou hast prepared before the face of all people;
a light to lighten the Gentiles,
and the glory of thy people Israel.
Glory be to the Father, and to the Son,
and to the Holy Ghost;
as it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be,
world without end. Amen.

The Peace Prayer

Lord, make me an instrument of your peace.
Where there is hatred, let me sow love;
where there is injury, pardon;
where there is doubt, faith;
where there is despair, hope;
where there is darkness, light;
where there is sadness, joy.
O Divine Master, grant that I may not so much seek
to be consoled as to console,
to be understood as to understand,
to be loved as to love.
For it is in giving that we receive,
it is in pardoning that we are pardoned,
and it is in dying that we are born to eternal life.
Amen.

Sanctus


SANCTUS
Sanctus, Sanctus, Sanctus
Dominus Deus Sabaoth.
Pleni sunt caeli et terra gloria tua.
Hosanna in excelsis.
Benedictus qui venit
in nomine Domini.
Hosanna in excelsis.

Holy, holy, holy, Lord God of hosts.
Heaven and earth are full of thy glory.
Glory be to thee, O Lord Most High.
Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord.
Hosanna in the highest.

The Serenity Prayer

God, grant me the serenity
to accept the things I cannot change,
courage to change the things I can,
and wisdom to know the difference.
Amen.